MBARARA UNIVERSITY COMPUTING STUDENTS ASSOCIATION

Enhancing Technological Innovations

PRESIDENTIAL MANIFESTO

Academic Year 2026/ 2027

Candidate

MUBIRU ELTON FELIX

Candidate for President, MUCOSA

"Build. Share. Launch."

01 Acknowledgement & Tribute

I stand here today as a candidate fully aware that I am stepping into a legacy not an empty slate. The outgoing MUCOSA cabinet, led by **Joronimo Amanya**, laid a foundation that deserves nothing short of genuine recognition and deep appreciation.

Under Joronimo's leadership, MUCOSA achieved something that many student associations struggle to sustain: **consistency**. The Friday sessions became a fixture, a reliable, weekly gathering that students could count on. Attendance grew. Energy grew. The culture of showing up and learning together grew.

But beyond the numbers, the previous cabinet opened a **platform for student voices**. They made room for students to step up, contribute, collaborate, and lead. That gift of being seen and heard within your own community is priceless.

> **To Joronimo Amanya and the entire outgoing cabinet:** Thank you. The seeds you planted are already growing. What we build next stands on everything you gave this association.

As **Mubiru Elton Felix**, I do not take lightly what it means to inherit this responsibility. I know I have big shoes to fill. I know the task at hand is not just to maintain what has been built but to **amplify it**, push its edges, and take MUCOSA further than it has ever gone before together with the new cabinet.

02 My Vision for MUCOSA

MUCOSA exists to do what lectures cannot. The classroom gives students knowledge. **MUCOSA gives students confidence, community, and connection to the real world.**

I believe MUCOSA should be three things at once:

- **A Launch Pad;** propelling students into internships, hackathons, national competitions, and tech communities far beyond Mbarara.
- **A Stage;** giving every student (from first year to final year), a platform to show what they are building, learning, and imagining.
- **A Brand;** making MUCOSA visible and respected not just within the Faculty of Computing, but across the university, across Uganda, and in the wider African tech ecosystem.

Every initiative in this manifesto serves one of these three purposes. Nothing I am proposing is theoretical. Everything is **actionable, measurable, and rooted in what I know our students need.**

03 The Five Pillars of My Manifesto

01 Events & Competitions Awareness Pipeline

Keep students informed, excited, and ready for every opportunity.

Uganda's tech ecosystem is more active than most students realize. Events like **PyCon Uganda, ICT Innovation Hub programs, CITT build competitions**, and national hackathons happen regularly and regularly, MUST students miss them because they heard about them a day too late or didn't feel prepared enough to participate.

MUCOSA under my leadership will become the definitive events radar for computing students at MUST.

The awareness pipeline:

- **Event Calendar:** A monthly shared calendar (WhatsApp, Notion, or a simple Google Sheet) listing every upcoming tech event in Mbarara and Uganda with deadlines, registration links, and eligibility details.
- **Post-Event Sessions:** When students attend external events, they come back and share at the next MUCOSA Friday, what they saw, who they met, what they learnt. This multiplies the value of one student's experience across the whole association.
- **Pre-Event Briefings:** For major competitions like CITT build challenges or national hackathons, MUCOSA will run short prep sessions so students arrive with a team, an idea, and confidence.
- **Industry Experience Sharing:** Inviting students who have attended events to describe their experience during Friday sessions making the idea of attending feel achievable and exciting to others.

02 Student-Led Tech Communities & Ambassadors

Expand MUCOSA's community portfolio and develop student ambassadors.

MUCOSA already operates alongside excellent communities — **GDG Mbarara, Women Techmakers**, and others. These partnerships are valuable. But we need to go further and bring more student-led community programs under the MUCOSA umbrella.

Target communities to onboard:

- **AWS Student Community:** Cloud computing is one of the fastest-growing skills in the job market. An AWS student club at MUST opens doors to certifications, cloud credits, and AWS-sponsored events.
- **Notion Campus Leader Program:** Notion is a tool that transforms how students organize their work and projects. A Notion ambassador can run workshops that immediately improve every student's productivity.
- **GitHub Campus Program:** GitHub Education offers free tools, certifications, and resources. A GitHub Campus Expert is a recognized tech leader and that badge travels with you into the industry.
- **Microsoft Learn Student Ambassadors (MLSA):** A globally recognized program with access to Azure credits, mentorship, and international events.

- **And more:** MongoDB, Postman, Auth0, JetBrains — the list of companies that actively want student communities is long. We tap into it.

Each community program produces **student ambassadors**, students with recognized credentials, direct industry connections, and a mandate to run workshops and events. Ambassadors are MUCOSA's most powerful alumni-in-the-making.

03 Show & Tell Fridays — Student Demo Sessions

Transform select Friday sessions into a stage for student builders and researchers.

The Friday sessions are already MUCOSA's greatest asset. I want to build on that momentum by introducing **"Show & Tell Fridays"**, dedicated sessions where students take the stage not to be taught, but to **show what they have built or researched.**

This is not a presentation competition. It is an open, encouraging environment where a first-year can demo a simple website they coded in their hostel room, and a third-year can walk through a machine learning project they have been researching. Both matter. Both inspire. No offence.

What this achieves:

- **Motivation:** Seeing a fellow student build something real is the most powerful motivator there is, far more than watching a YouTube tutorial.
- **Curiosity:** The audience gets to ask "how did you build that?" — sparking peer-to-peer learning that no lecture can replicate.
- **Hackathon Readiness:** Regular demo practice directly prepares students for university hackathons, CITT build competitions, and national events where pitching and presenting your work is half the battle.
- **Soft Launch Culture:** We cultivate a generation of students who are comfortable shipping work in progress, a mindset that defines great engineers.

04 MUCOSA Media — Cinematic Session Recaps

Document every Friday session and release polished weekly content.

Imagine this: every Monday morning, students across the university and students who couldn't make it to Friday's session wake up to a **short, cinematic recap video** of what happened. A five-minute edit. Great music. Real moments. Real learning. Real people.

This is what MUCOSA Media does. We document our sessions with the same creative energy that the tech world documents its own story.

The content pipeline:

- **Video Recap (5 mins):** A weekly cinematic edit of the Friday session with key moments, key lessons, atmosphere.
- **Written Summary:** A concise written breakdown of what was discussed or built shared on LinkedIn, WhatsApp groups, and MUCOSA socials.

- **Short-Form Clips:** 60-second highlights cut for TikTok and Instagram Reels reaching students who haven't joined or been to MUCOSA yet.

Why this matters:

- **Attendance Incentive:** Students who see the energy of a session they missed will show up the next Friday. Fear of missing out is a powerful motivator.
- **Student Creators Get Credit:** Every video will credit the videographers, editors, and graphic designers involved — building their portfolios in public and creating real opportunities that stem directly from MUCOSA work.
- **Visibility & Brand:** A MUCOSA TikTok account or LinkedIn page with consistent, high-quality content makes us visible to recruiters, sponsors, partner organizations, and potential guest speakers from industry.
- **Digital Archive:** Every session becomes a resource that future students can learn from. We stop losing knowledge when great speakers come and go.

> *This turns every Friday session into a content moment. Students who can't code will find their role as editors, directors, and designers. MUCOSA becomes a cross-disciplinary creative community — not just a coding club.*

05 Session Experience — Refreshments & Comfort

Fuel our students through every Friday session.

Last but not least, this one is simple, human, and important. A 2-to-3-hour Friday session demands sustained attention. Industry experts, guest speakers, and student presenters deserve an audience that is **present, energized, and engaged** — not distracted by hunger or fatigue.

My aim is to make **drinks and light snacks** a standard feature of MUCOSA Friday sessions. This is not a luxury it is an investment in the quality of attention and learning in the room.

How we sustain this:

- **Student Contribution Model:** A transparent, voluntary contribution model where students make an initial shs.5,000 contribution at the beginning of the year.

05 A Personal Commitment

I am not running for this position to just add a fancy title to my name. I am running because I genuinely believe that **MUCOSA can be the most impactful thing that happens to both computing student and non-computing students at Mbarara University** more than any single course unit, more than any single exam.

I believe MUCOSA should be the place where a student discovers they can code something people use. Where they meet the senior who tells them about the internship that changed their life. Where they stand in front of a room and present for the first time and realize they were never as frightened as they thought they were.

That is what a launch pad looks like. And **that is what I am committing to build.**

> **I ask for your vote not as a favor, but as a shared bet on what MUCOSA can become. Let us build something worth documenting.**

Presented by

MUBIRU ELTON FELIX

Presidential Candidate — MUCOSA 2026/2027

Faculty of Computing and Informatics, Mbarara University of Science and Technology

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